

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Damaging winds

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Shelter inside a sturdy building away from windows when damaging winds threaten. Avoid trees, power lines and lightweight structures. Follow tornado warnings separately; straight-line winds can also cause severe damage.

Do now.

**Secure items beforehand**

01

Bring loose items inside while conditions are calm; do not go out once winds are dangerous.

**Use an interior room**

02

Stay away from glass and large exterior openings.

**Limit driving**

03

High-profile vehicles are vulnerable; avoid routes lined with falling trees or debris.

**Keep clear afterward**

04

Assume downed lines are live and report them from a safe distance.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Wait for winds to ease in the best shelter you can reach without exposure. Keep a torch and shoes nearby for broken glass. If the building is failing, move to a safer reachable space without going beneath trees, loose roofing or wires.

Watch for.

Do not attempt to clear a tree from a power line.

People & practical needs.

Account for children, older people, pets and anyone who needs assistance before moving. Keep shoes, medicines and a torch in the shelter area

Next decision.

Inspect damage without entering unstable buildings. Arrange help for trees touching wires.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Damaging winds · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/damaging-winds/>